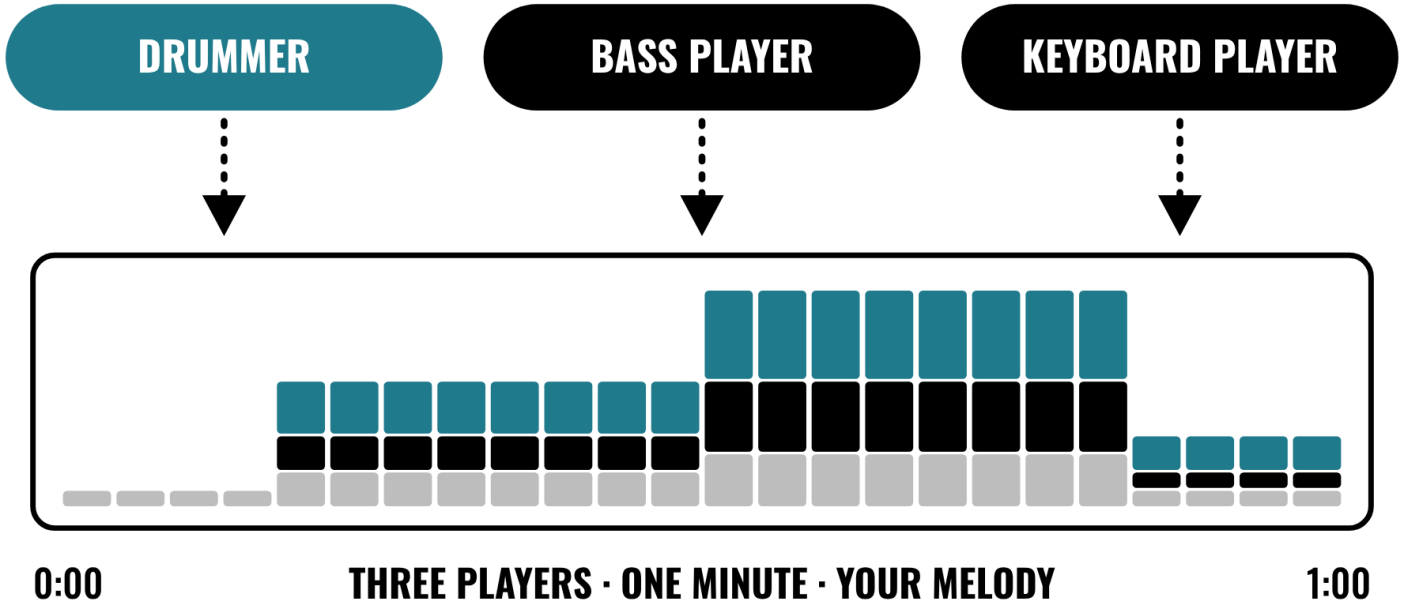
HUDSON BEAT



SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Build a band without the band.

THINK: WHAT DOES A BAND DO?

THINK, THEN SHARE

Teacher: describe a band playing the same slow song twice, first quietly and simply, then loud and busy. No audio is needed.

- What did the drummer change?
- What stayed the same?
- Who wrote the melody?

WHAT IS SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO?

- Build a band without the band
- Drummer, Bass Player and Keyboard Player
- Customize style, groove and complexity
- Add your own melody on top

SEVEN CLASSES

CLASS 1	Build a band · five steps · five words · set up and choose chords
CLASS 2	Customize style, groove and complexity
CLASS 3	Working day: arrange, energy, worked example
CLASS 4	Working day: add your melody
CLASS 5	Working day: refine and mix
CLASS 6	Checklist · rubric
CLASS 7	Presentations with Padlet Q&A

FIVE STEPS, THEN FINISH



Then mix, bounce, present and get feedback

- Load three Session Players
- Customize, then arrange
- Choose a chord progression
- Add your melody, mix, present

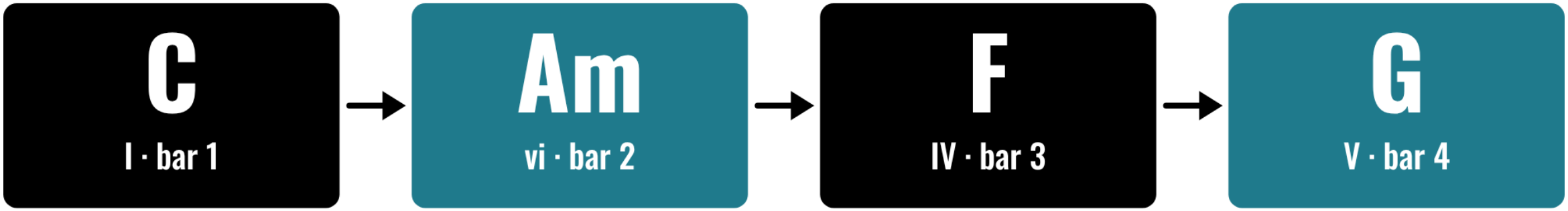
FIVE WORDS TO KNOW

- Session Player: a virtual musician that plays for you
- Groove: how tight, loose or swinging it feels
- Complexity: how busy or simple a part is
- Chord progression: the chords under a piece
- Arrangement: how sections and instruments are laid out

STEPS 1 AND 2: SET UP, CHOOSE CHORDS

1. Load Drummer, Bass Player and Keyboard Player
2. Borrow a chord progression or make your own
3. Stuck? Start from the Chord cheat sheet
4. Write your chords on the Arrangement plan

A FOUR-BAR CHORD LOOP



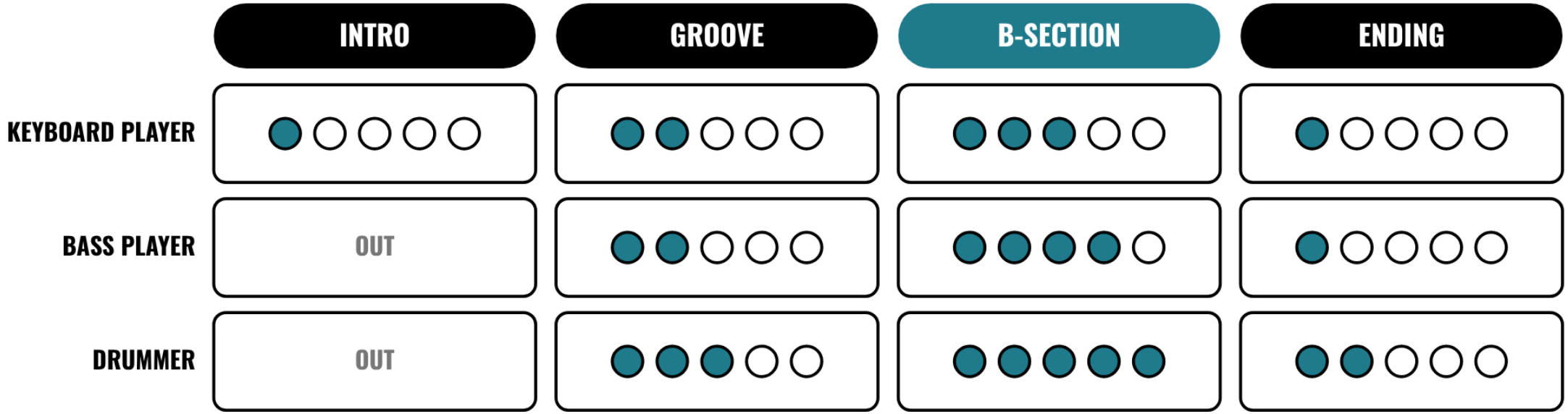
Four bars, one chord each, then repeat. This is the loop under “Porch Light”.

- An invented loop, on paper
- Repeat it under every section
- One chord for each bar
- Change it in the B-section

STEP 3: CUSTOMIZE

1. Adjust each player’s style, groove and complexity
2. You can change the instrument a player uses
3. The player makes the notes; you choose the sound
4. Write your settings on the Players sheet

SAME PLAYERS, DIFFERENT SETTINGS



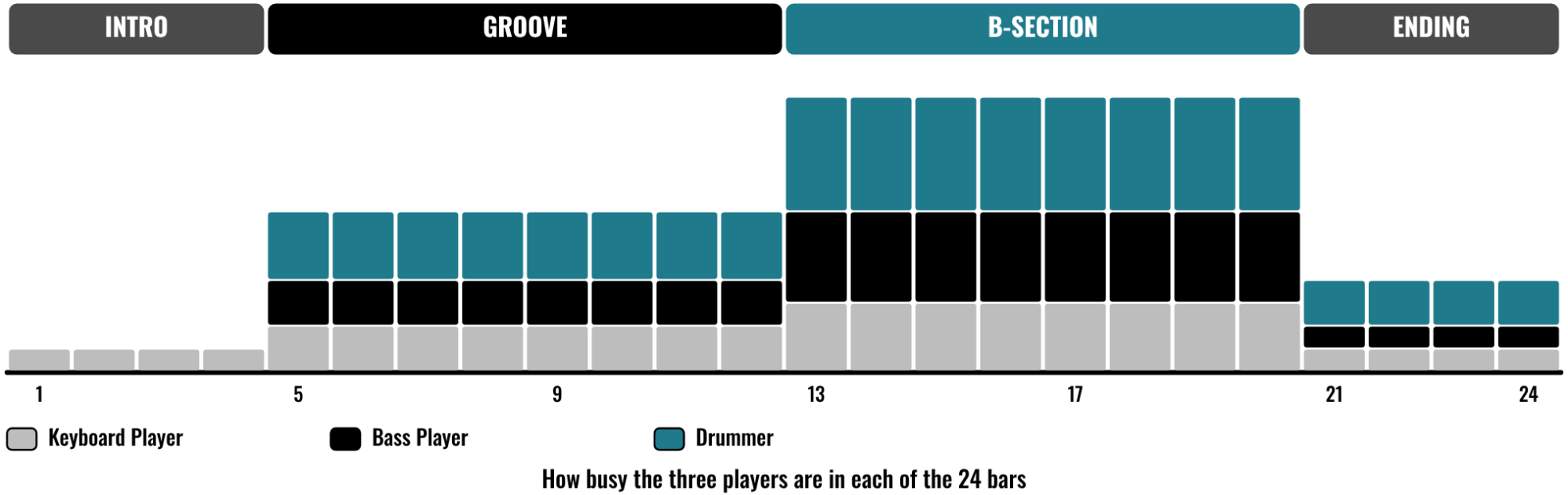
Complexity from 1 (simple) to 5 (busy), by section: an invented example

- Same players in every section
- Keys are simple in the intro
- The settings are what change
- The B-section is the busiest

STEP 4: ARRANGE

1. Build an intro, main groove and ending
2. Vary the energy between sections
3. Change Drummer patterns and Bass complexity per section
4. Plan it on the Arrangement plan

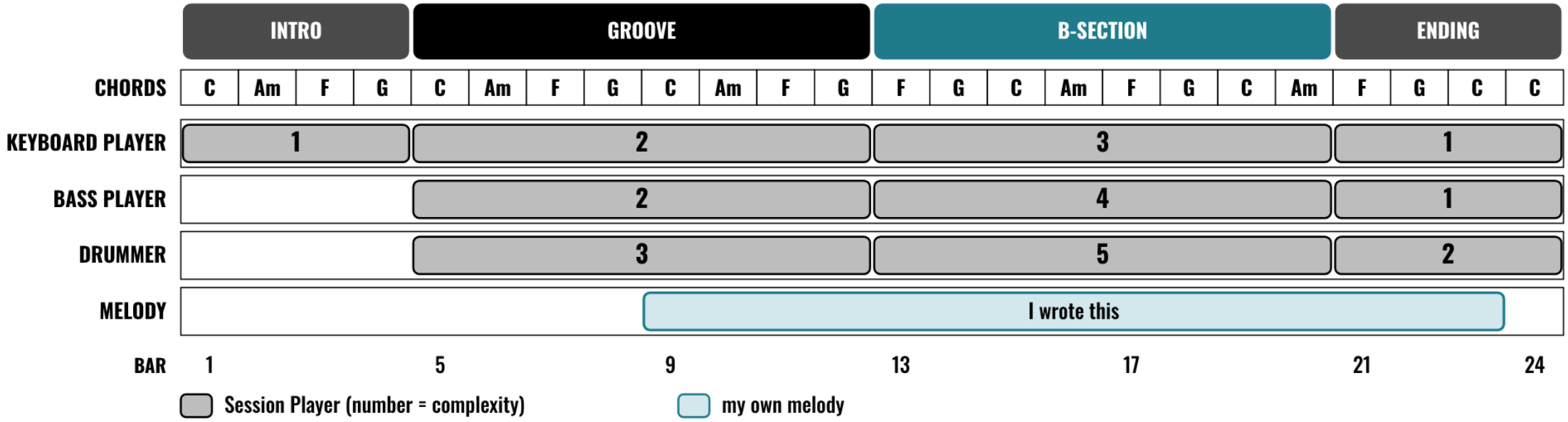
ENERGY OVER ONE MINUTE



How busy the three players are in each of the 24 bars

- An invented piece, on paper
- The B-section is the peak
- Small intro, bigger groove
- The ending thins out

WORKED EXAMPLE: 60 SECONDS



- An invented 60-second piece
- A chord for every bar
- Four sections you can name
- Your melody sits on top

STEP 5: ADD YOUR MELODY

- Record or program an original melody
- The melody is what makes this yours
- Spend real time on it
- Use chord tones on the strong beats

STEP 6: MIX AND FINALIZE

- Balance levels
- Apply EQ and effects
- Bounce your track
- Can you hear your melody over the band?

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Session Player's Studio
- [ ] At least 3 Session Players with custom settings
- [ ] Padlet post with 3 questions
- [ ] Answer 2 questions on classmates' posts

HOW IT'S SCORED

CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	5 = Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems	/ 5
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	5 = Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc	/ 5
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	5 = Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery	/ 5

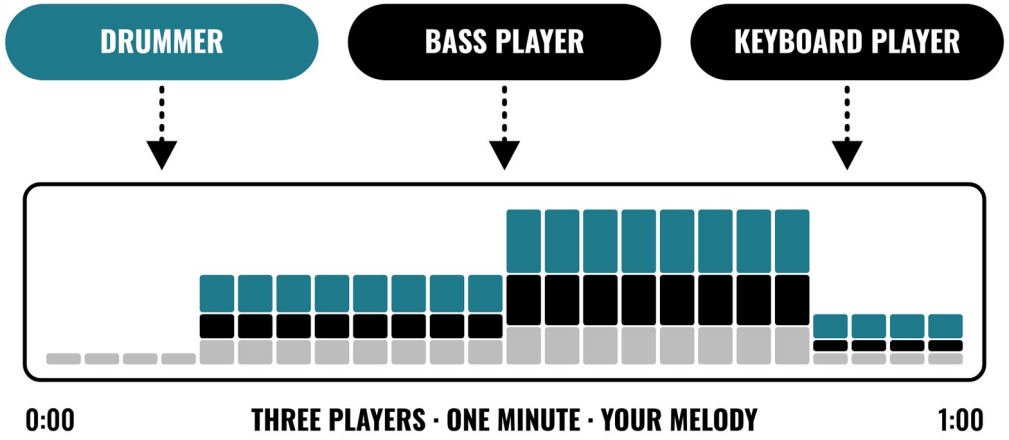
SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25

PRESENTATION DAY

- Play your track; name your three players
- Say what you changed in the intro and the peak
- Your Padlet post: 3 questions about your project
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s 3

ONE LAST THING...

- You built a band.
- You shaped every part.
- You wrote the melody.
- Now press play.



REFLECTION · PAGE 24

Write it or talk it through: what went well, what was hard, what you would change.